saw me coming and dropped the ball short. I tried to adapt and, looking rather ungainly, ended up going down on one knee and slog-sweeping the ball to deep mid-wicket.

'What kind of cricket is that?' Matthew Hayden scoffed, fielding at slip. 'What is this guy doing?'

'I'll show you one day, bud,' I said to myself.

So I stored away the irritation.

Only 187 runs required, I ponder. Only 187 runs required to silence the doubters. Jacques and I finally reach the crease and execute the standard cricketer's fist-pump before heading to our respective ends. He looks so calm and confident. I look at him and feel confident as well.

We enjoy batting together. In fact, our last four partnerships in Test matches have been worth 112, 5, 256 and 124. Come on, I mutter quietly, let's get this done.

The Australians are running in hard, hunting early wickets, but we continue to prosper until, with our partnership worth 124 runs, exactly as many as our partnership in the first innings, Jacques is caught by Mike Hussey off Mitchell Johnson for 57. We are 303 for four, with 111 runs still required to win.

JP Duminy, playing his Test debut, joins me in the middle. He scored one in our first innings and looks understandably nervous, but I very clearly remember our partnership while playing for South Africa Under-19 against England at Worcester six years earlier. We'd done it before and we can do it again.

The Australians are working hard, running in with real conviction, chatting, unnerving. We are playing carefully, taking few risks, gutsing it out and seizing anything loose. We reach lunch at 322 for four, and start to sense that the home side is getting nervous. We cajole our score to 362 for four by drinks in the afternoon. The sledging is almost non-stop now, between every ball, between every over, but JP and I hear nothing.